Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/williamroper (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

National Security
Defense
Government

Honors-Awards

Award for Excellence: Asia-Pacific Rebalance
Innovation Award: European Phased Adaptive Approach
Technology Award: Unmanned Airborne Systems
Contractor of the Year
Rhodes Scholar

Will Roper

Istari CEO. Georgia Tech Professor. Digital Enthusiast!
United States

Summary

String theorist turned Georgia Tech Professor and startup CEO. 13th U.S. Air and Space Forces Weapons Chief. Active Traveler. Avid Hiker. Able Pelotoner. Ardent Father. :)

Experience

Istari
Chief Executive Officer
May 2022 - Present (4 years 3 months)
Boston, MA

Honeywell Aerospace
Board Member
June 2026 - Present (2 months)
Phoenix, AZ

Georgia Institute of Technology
Distinguished Professor of the Practice
March 2022 - Present (4 years 5 months)
Atlanta, Georgia, United States

Royal Air Force (RAF)
Honorary Group Captain
August 2021 - Present (5 years)

Insight Partners
Government Advisory Board
February 2022 - Present (4 years 6 months)
New York, New York, United States

Georgia Tech Research Institute
Executive Advisory Committee Member
January 2024 - Present (2 years 7 months)
Atlanta, Georgia, United States

J.F. Lehman & Company
Advisory Board
February 2022 - Present (4 years 6 months)
New York, New York, United States

Hermeus
Board Member
April 2021 - Present (5 years 4 months)

Ursa Major Technologies
Board Member
April 2021 - Present (5 years 4 months)
United States

RED 6
Advisory Board Member
March 2021 - Present (5 years 5 months)

Defense Innovation Board
Defense Innovation Board
October 2022 - April 2025 (2 years 7 months)

Beta Technologies
Board Member
April 2021 - October 2024 (3 years 7 months)

Firehawk Aerospace
Board Member
March 2021 - January 2024 (2 years 11 months)
Texas, United States

McKinsey & Company
Senior Advisor
April 2021 - October 2023 (2 years 7 months)

United States Air Force
Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Acquisition, Technology, & Logistics)
February 2018 - January 2021 (3 years)
Washington D.C. Metro Area

Office of the Secretary of Defense
Founding Director, Strategic Capabilities Office
August 2012 - February 2018 (5 years 7 months)
Washington D.C. Metro Area

Missile Defense Agency
Chief Architect
May 2010 - August 2012 (2 years 4 months)

MIT Lincoln Laboratory
Technical Staff
January 2006 - May 2012 (6 years 5 months)

Office of the Secretary of Defense
Missile Defense Advisory Committee Member
August 2009 - August 2010 (1 year 1 month)

Education

University of Oxford
Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.), Mathematics · (2003 - 2008)

Georgia Institute of Technology
Master's Degree, Physics · (2001 - 2002)

Georgia Institute of Technology
Bachelor's Degree, Physics · (1998 - 2001)